

Teenagers learn, socialise and express themselves online. These experiences are often positive, but can come with risks.

How can parents and carers offer support?

Online Safety Act 2023

UK law now requires online platforms to protect children by default. Platforms must limit harmful content, stop unwanted contacts and keep young people's data private.

For more info



1. Keep communication open

Talk regularly about what your teen does online, not just when there's a problem. Stay calm and curious and reassure them they won't be in trouble for asking for help.

3. Talk about privacy and sharing

Make sure your teen understands that once something is shared online it can have consequences. Our advice is to require a private account, restrict messaging to friends only, keep location sharing off and content filters on.

5. Address online bullying and pressure

It is okay to block and report someone, you don't have to respond. If it is someone your teen knows, seek early support from school/club and save the evidence. Online bullying is painful, listen to your teen's feelings and validate them.

2. Agree boundaries together

Check your teen is using their real age on all their accounts, otherwise safety protections won't work. Set shared expectations about screen time, apps and how you will monitor their online behaviour. Explain the why, not just the rules. You can review these boundaries as they earn trust.

4. Discuss online relationships and grooming

People online may not be who they claim to be. Grooming can seem like friendship to start with. But, people you don't know in real life offering you gifts, asking for images or sharing secrets are a red flag.

6. Give them a clear safety plan

Make sure they know they can come to you anytime and they won't get into trouble for being honest. Keep it simple: if something goes wrong online try.

Stop • Don't reply • Block • Save • Tell

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